



Research – Innovate – Disseminate – Transform Livelihoods

2ND

KALRO SCIENTIFIC CONFERENCE AND INNOVATION EXPO

15th–19th June 2026 | KALRO Headquarters

**Innovations for sustainable Agri-food systems,
climate change resilience and improved
livelihoods**

SIDE EVENTS PROGRAMME

WEDNESDAY 17TH – THURSDAY 18TH JUNE 2026

**Bringing Together Partners, Innovators &
Development Actors**

Virtual: To be communicated



KALRO Headquarters, Kaptagat
Road, Loresho, Nairobi



conference@kalro.org;
kalroconference2026@gmail.com
expo@kalro.org



Cell: 0722 206 986, 0722 206 988, 0709 104 000

Overview

The 2nd KALRO Scientific Conference & Innovation Expo will host a series of Side Events designed to extend the reach of the main conference beyond plenary sessions and technical paper presentations. These Side Events offer an unparalleled platform for focused dialogue, collaborative learning, and the forging of new partnerships across the agricultural research and development landscape.

Facilitated by a distinguished group of leading partners, national and international organizations, universities, development programmes, and innovation centres, the Side Events bring together scientists, policymakers, private sector actors, development practitioners, and the next generation of agricultural researchers. Together, they explore the most pressing challenges and exciting opportunities facing African food systems today.

Why Attend the Side Events?

The Side Events programme has been deliberately curated to complement the conference's core scientific themes while creating space for deeper, more interactive engagement. Whether you are a researcher seeking collaboration, a development practitioner looking for evidence-based tools, or a young scientist building your professional network, the Side Events offer something of value for every delegate.

Each Side Event is hosted by a sponsoring organisation with deep expertise and a strong track record of working within Kenya and the broader African agricultural landscape. Topics span the full spectrum of modern agricultural science — from climate-smart crop and livestock technologies, to pest and disease management, digital advisory services, nutrition-sensitive value chains, and the critical role of women's leadership in driving agricultural transformation.

Thematic Focus Areas

The Side Events collectively address five overarching thematic pillars that define the future of food and agriculture in Africa:

1 Climate-Smart Agriculture & Resilient Food Systems

Addressing the escalating impacts of climate change on agricultural productivity through innovative technologies, early warning systems, and community-based adaptation strategies.

2 Pest & Disease Management and Crop Health

Showcasing the latest advances in integrated pest management, biocontrol technologies, and plant health clinic approaches that are transforming how smallholder farmers protect their crops.

3 Agri-Food Innovation, Entrepreneurship & Digital Tools

Exploring how digital platforms, data-driven advisory services, and agri-entrepreneurship are opening new frontiers for productivity, market access, and food system efficiency.

4 Gender, Inclusion & Youth in Agricultural Research

Championing the indispensable role of women scientists and young researchers in shaping the future of African agriculture, with a focus on leadership, mentorship, and career development.

5 Nutrition, Value Chains & Market Linkages

Bridging the gap between agricultural production and nutritional outcomes, with attention to post-harvest management, market systems development, and inclusive value chain approaches.

Side Events Hosts

We extend our sincere gratitude to the following organizations for their generous partnership, intellectual contribution, and commitment to making the Side Events a vibrant and enriching component of the 2nd KALRO Scientific Conference:

The 2026 Side Events are made possible through the partnership and intellectual leadership of distinguished partners:

- KALRO and its research centres
- FAO
- Strathmore Agri-Food Innovation Center (SAFIC)
- CIMMYT
- IITA
- Egerton University
- ILRI
- Alliance of Bioversity International & CIAT
- AFA
- Private sector innovators and value chain actors

Each side event enriches the deliberations of the 2nd KALRO Conference and the partner organizations provide deep expertise and a strong track record of advancing Kenya's agricultural transformation agenda.



Side events Programme at a Glance

Date and Time	Side Event Title	Host Organisation
Wednesday 17th June 2026		
09:30–14:30	Better Analytics for reduced impact of extreme Weather Events	KALRO/FAO Loss and Damage Project
11:00–13:00	AI in Agriculture; Opportunities, Implications and Risks	Strathmore Agri-Food Innovation Center
11:00–13:00	Creating market for the Tsetse Fly Shield™ repellent	KALRO
13:00–16:00	From Research to Impact: How KALRO and CIMMYT Are Advancing Agricultural Innovation	CIMMYT-Kenya
14:00–17:00	Emerging Food Safety Challenges and Opportunities: Bridging Research, Regulation, Policy, and Industry for Safer Foods	KALRO, IITA, Egerton University
Thursday 18th June 2026		
09:00–11:00	Sustainable Livestock in Kenya: Unlocking Economic, Environmental, and Social Benefits	ILRI
10:00–12:30	Accelerating Sustainable Production, Market Trade and Consumption	ALLIANCE OF BIO-DIVERSITY INTERNATIONAL AND CIAT
11:00–13:00	Business session - Cassava starch processing, which way forward	KALRO/AFA
14:00–16:00	Business session – ECF Vaccine commercialization	KALRO

A Note to Delegates

The Side Events are open to all registered conference delegates. We strongly encourage participants to engage with at least one Side Event during the conference programme. The conversations, connections, and insights generated in these sessions have historically proven to be among the most impactful outcomes of the KALRO Biennial Scientific Conference.

Details of each Side Event, including timing, venue, facilitators, and registration requirements, are available in the side events program to be availed on the conference webpage and a QR code will be available on the official conference notice board near the registration desk.

We look forward to welcoming you to an inspiring and productive series of Side Events.